

Theme

Clutch Vs. Player Reputation (NBA)

Examines whether players with more accolades and/or reputation (All-Star/All-NBA selections) actually perform better under pressure compared to “regular”/role players by comparing clutch stats to season averages.

Source

NBA play-by-play and shot tracking data via the [nba_api](#) Python Package. The API Data is collected from stats.nba.com

Motivation

Casual fans tend to overlook role players in the NBA and misunderstand their impact due to the reputation of star players taking the limelight away in clutch situations. The data here can help replace the reputation-driven assumptions with a data-driven assessment of who actually performs better under pressure.

Sub-Questions

1. Does clutch-time efficiency (TS%) match season-long efficiency for star players, or is there a gap between them and the role players?
2. When a star player underperforms in the clutch situation, is it driven by specific defender/team matchup rather than a decline in general performance?
3. Do Home/Road splits show a measurable difference in clutch advantage?
4. Do shot selections (location, type) play a role in clutch efficiency?

Data Summary

Clutch stats (final 5 min, score within 5 pts) can be found using the [LeagueDashPlayerClutch/PlayerDashboardByClutch](#) endpoints. Season stats can be found in the [LeagueDashPlayerStats](#) endpoint. Player accolades (All-Star, All-NBA, MVP) can be found at [PlayerAwards](#) to classify “star” and role players. Shot location data can be found in [ShotChartDetail](#). And opponent-filtered box scores can be found in [BoxScoreAdvancedV3](#).

Core Metrics:

True Shooting % (TS%), Effective Field Goal % (eFG%), Usage % (USG%), Net Rating, Plus/Minus, Player Impact Estimate (PIE)